

Knight's Quest Game Manual

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Version 1.0

1 Quick Start

- Double click on **KNIGHTSQUEST.d64** disk image and the **LOAD “*”,8,1** command should be executed by your C64 Emulator
- Or... open your C64 emulator of choice, then attach the **KNIGHTSQUEST.d64** disk image, run the command **LOAD “*”,8,1**, then type **RUN**

2 Game Play

Important Keys

To change the keybindings, please see the *Configuration* section.

- Q allows the user to quit the game, and is effectively a “pause” function
- 1 (the number one) allows the user to Save or Load a previous game. **Saving a game replaces the previous game saved...** you can only have 1 saved game at a time!

Player control with the keyboard

To change the keybindings, please see the *Configuration* section.

- U moves Sir Seiröl to the left
- O moves him to the right

- I moves him up
- K moves him down
- The space-bar attacks
- S creates a magical shield around Sir Seirol... you'll see his staff turn white while the shield is engaged.

Player control with the Joystick

- Stick moves Sir Seirol
- Fire button attacks
- Down and Fire button (at the same time) engages the shield (as describe above).

Special Actions

To change the keybindings, please see the *Configuration* section.

- If the player has purchased a map of the level, pressing the letter 'M' displays said map and pauses the game.
- If the player has the Stadex Blast spell, 'X' casts it. Using a Stadex Blast decreases the Sir Seirol's Experience points so, use them sparingly!
- If the player has the Orasty Potion, 'V' makes Sir Seirol drink it.
- If the player has a Key, they can attempt to unlock a door by walking right up to it. If the door is not unlockable with a key, then it will remain closed.

Stats

- Lives: Seirol starts out with three lives. He acquires an additional life after completing every two missions (when he completes mission 2, 4, 6, and 8).
- Staff Quality: The Quality of Seirol's staff affects how many hit points his opponents lose during a battle. It can be repaired in the shop (which brings it closer to being in new condition). You can also buy a new one (of the same quality) or upgrade to a higher quality staff.

- Staff Usage: Every time Seirol uses his staff it loses a bit of quality.
- Hit Points: The more hit points Seirol has, the more he can withstand an enemy. As his experience points rise, so does the maximum number of hit points he has. The maximum hit point value is 150.
- Experience Points: The Good Sir Seirol gains experience for many things: Winning a battle, entering a new room, finding treasure, etc. The more experience he has, the more hit points he *could* have - up to 150. His experience points do not have a limit.
- Efficiency: This is not a *real* stat, but it can be used to determine how efficiently Seirol completes a mission. It's basically a count of how many new rooms the Good Sir Seirol has entered.

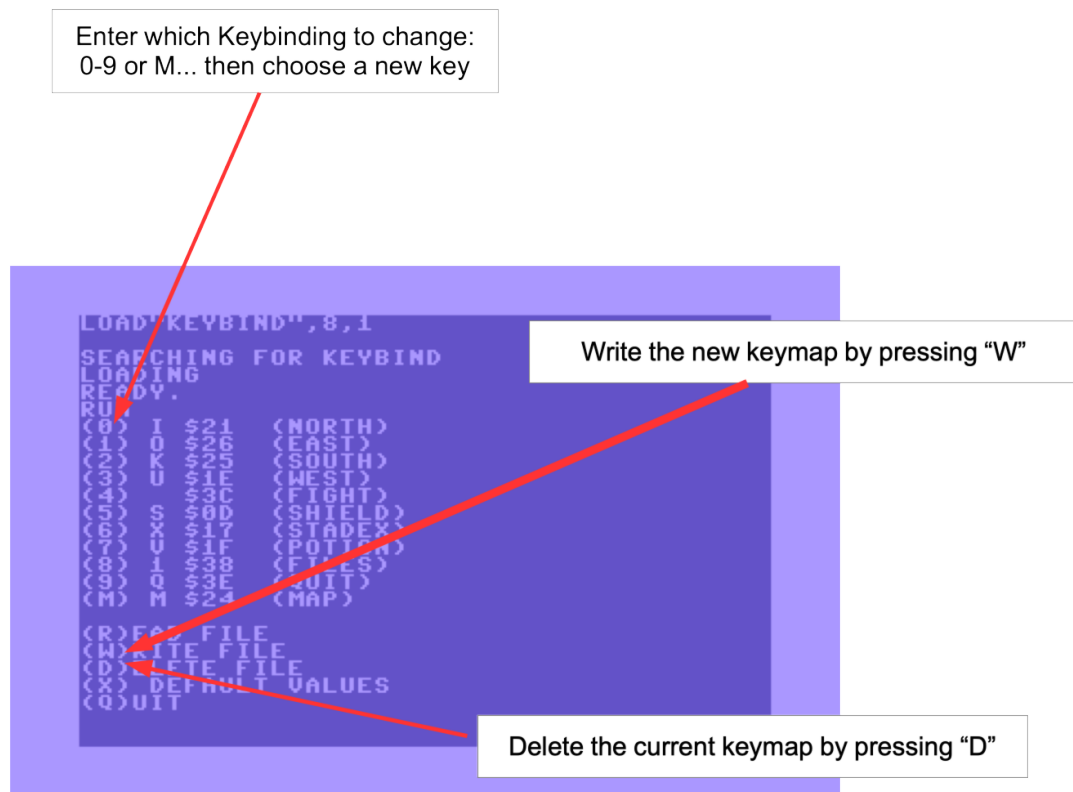
Configuration

Since the adage *different strokes for different folks* rings true, we here at HQ figured it'd be best to provide a way for folks to change which keystrokes do what in the game. Some people are partial to WASD as the directional control keys, while the creators of the game are partial to UIOK. Anyhow - there is a way to change the keybindings... and here it is, laid bare for all to see right here in the manual.

If you are using an emulator then run the emulator and mount the d64 image, **"KNIGHTSQUEST.d64"** and run the keybinding program by typing, **LOAD "KEYBIND",8,1**. If you are using the *real deal*, then just run the keybinding program.

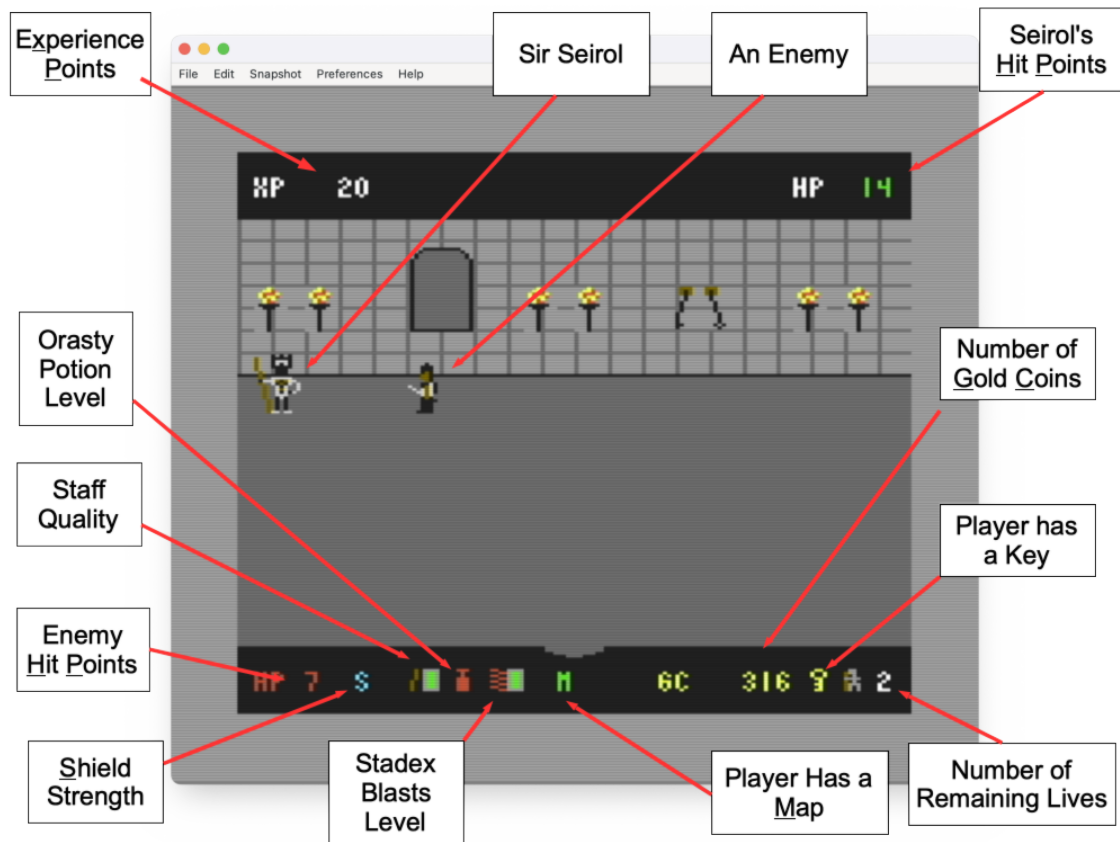
- 0-9 and M: By choosing one of these, you can change any of the current key-mappings.
- R: Read File will display the current keybindings that are saved on the disk. If there isn't a keymap file, it will produce an error message.
- W: Write File will write the keybindings to the disk in a keymap file. If a keymap file already exists, an error message will be produced; you must delete the current keymap file before writing a new one.
- D: Delete File will delete the keymap file that is on disk. If there isn't one, it will produce an error message.

- X: Default Values will reset the changed values to their defaults. It will not, however, write the file to disk.
- Q: Quit will exit the program. If you have unsaved changes, it will warn you first.



3 Screen Objects

Main Screen



Items



Steely



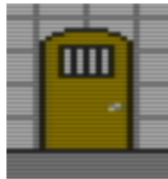
Unlocked Door/Gate



Seirol's Pink Staff
means he's been
cursed!!



Gold Coins



Locked Door/Gate



A Map on
the Wall



A Key

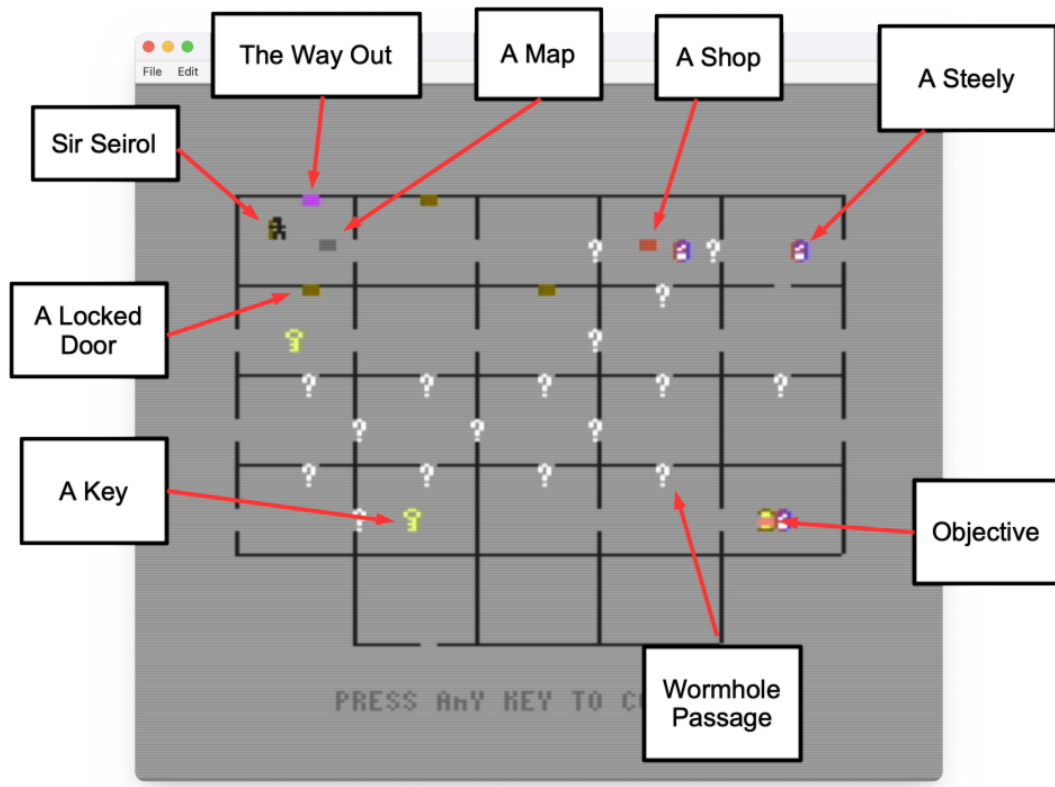


Health Pack/Orasty Root



Self Explanatory

Map



4 The Shop

In some rooms or clearings in the woods, Nicolas Knaves has opened up one of his pop-up shops where Sir Seirol can purchase things or have his staff serviced such as:

- Staff Repair: Over time, Sir Seirol's staff shows some wear-and-tear and doesn't cause as much damage as when it was new. Having Nicky Knaves repair his staff will bring it closer to "new" condition.
- New Staff: Nicky has new staffs available for purchase as well... they are always of the same quality as the staff that Seirol has at that moment.

- Upgrade Staff: This is a new staff that causes slightly more damage than the one Seirol has at present.
- Orasty Potion: This vial of liquid is just Orasty Root extract and works just like the root that is found throughout the land of Fade. Seirol doesn't need to wait to find Orasty Root in order to drink this potion. The player can just press 'V'.
- Fast Healing: Nicky will cast a spell on Sir Seirol that makes him heal faster than normal after an attack.
- Immunity Tincture: This will make Seirol immune to the Witch of the Wood for the current level. Her flying antics won't hurt him!
- Stadex Blast: This is a spell that Seirol can purchase. If he purchases it 3 times, he can then do 3 Stadex Blasts. What *IS* a Stadex Blast you ask? It performs an attack on every enemy in the room... even if they are far away from Sir Seirol. Each time the spell is used, Sir Seirol's experience points drop by 5. If he has less than 5 experience points, he cannot cast the spell. The player can press 'X' to make a Stadex Blast.
- Level Map: A map of the current level. If the player presses 'M', they can view it (this also pauses gameplay).
- A Key: A skeleton key that will open most locked doors (but not ALL!).

5 Objective

Each level (1-10) has its own objective that is explained in the synopsis before the level begins. In some levels Sir Seirol needs to obtain an object, in some levels he needs to kill a character.

The *general* objective is to smite enemies, acquire experience points and gold, and stay alive.

6 Navigation

Each indoor level is composed of rooms connected by north, south, east, and west doors (up, down, right, and left on your screen). North doors could be locked (see "Locked Doors and Gates" in this manual). Some doors are not connected (wormhole

portals) to each other... for instance, you might be in room A, go through a door into room B... turn around and go back the way you came and end up in room C.

You might find a map of the current level on a wall. To view it, just have Sir Seiol walk up to it.

Each *outdoor* level is composed of clearings in the Witches' Wood. They are connected by wooden gates to other clearings the same way rooms are connected in Lord Rorbit's Keep and they function in the same way as well.

Locked Doors and Gates

If you obtain a skeleton key (by either purchasing one at the **shop** or by finding one along the way) you may use it to unlock and pass through most locked doors and gates. Some, doors and gates, however, can only be unlocked by defeating an enemy. Sometimes that enemy is in the same room as the locked door, and sometimes the locked door is in some unknown location somewhere in the level.

Scoring

The more experience points you get, the better, and you can get experience points by:

- Entering a room you've never been in before
- Smiting a character
- Achieving an Objective
- Completing a level

You can **LOSE** experience points by casting a Stalex Blast spell.

The lower your efficiency level is, the better... if you can complete a level in fewer room-changes than everyone else... you're wicked efficient and that's good.

The more gold you collect, the better. Not only can you buy things with gold, but it can be used as a way to score how you play.

7 The Story

Spoiler Alerts!

If you read this section, it may spoil the surprise for some aspects of the game. We here at headquarters strongly recommend you read one section for every 2 levels of game play.

The Rescue of Princess Andora

The Land of Fade is a realm of magic and mystery, where time itself seems to stretch and twist like the tangled roots of the Witches' Wood. At its heart, beyond the gnarled trees and shadowed hollows, looms the dreaded Keep of Lord Rorbit; tall and forboding. The wicked sorcerer has long terrorized the kingdom, but his latest act of villainy is the most grievous of all—he had stolen away the beloved Princess Andora and locked her deep within his dungeons.

Sir Seiol, a valiant knight known for his unwavering courage and steadfast heart, has long admired the princess from afar. She is the light of the kingdom of Fade, graceful and kind, and to Sir Seiol, she was the very essence of goodness. He will not allow her to remain a prisoner in Rorbit's keep, no matter the dangers that lay ahead. Clad in black armor, staff in hand, he set forth into the haunted realm, determined to rescue her from the clutches of evil.

The Keep of Lord Rorbit

Lord Rorbit's keep is a place of shadow and peril. Its halls stretch endlessly, twisting and curling upon themselves in an unnatural maze. Ordinary doors lead from room to room, but in some chambers, passages could transport someone to anywhere within the confines of the keep and whisk unsuspecting travelers into distant corners and unknown hallways. To navigate the fortress without losing one's way is a feat in itself, but Sir Seiol can steel his mind against the trickery that lay in wait.

Scattered throughout the keep are treasures, relics of past conquests, and health packs left behind by unfortunate souls who had perished in their attempts to escape. But the keep is not unguarded. Rorbit's minions roam its halls—twisted creatures of dark magic, clad in jagged armor and eager to strike down any who oppose their master.

Seiol knows that his mission is not as simple as finding Andora. The princess is shackled by enchanted chains, and the key to her bonds lay hidden somewhere

within the keep. Every step forward will be a gamble, every doorway a potential trap, but the knight should press on, driven by duty and love.

The Orb of Inx and the Curse of the Orb of Inx

Lord Rorbit's strength is drawn from a singular source—the Orb of Inx. This malevolent artifact pulses with dark energy, feeding the sorcerer's power and warping the keep into its chaotic state. Without it, Rorbit would be far easier to defeat, but there is a terrible price for taking the Orb. Those who seized it found themselves unable to navigate the world as they once had. Paths became nonsensical, doors led to places they never should, and a simple journey could stretch into an endless nightmare.

Would Seirol dare to steal the Orb, knowing that it could cost him his way through the fortress? Would he be willing to risk losing himself forever in the labyrinth if it meant weakening Rorbit?

The Witch and the Book of Spells

The Witches' Wood has long been home to a powerful sorceress, one whose name was spoken in hushed whispers by the people of Fade. She has long coveted Rorbit's Book of Spells, a tome of immeasurable power. With it, she could rise above all others and rule the Land of Fade with an iron grip.

But there is more to this story than simple ambition. The Witch and Rorbit had once been bound by love, their union producing a daughter they could not—or would not—raise. That daughter had been taken in by the King and Queen of Fade, raised as their own, and had grown into the radiant Princess Andora.

She knows nothing of her true heritage, nor of the dark power that slumbered within her veins. She had inherited both her parents' magical abilities, and perhaps, their evil tendencies as well. What would happen if she were to discover the truth? If the Book of Spells fell into her hands, would she rise as the savior of Fade or its conqueror?

The Final Choice

As Seirol ventures deeper into the keep, battling minions and avoiding treacherous wormholes, he knows his quest would not end with merely unlocking Andora's shackles. He would have to decide whether to claim the Orb of Inx and risk becoming lost in the keep's madness. He would have to consider whether to take the

Book of Spells for himself or let the Witch claim it, knowing the consequences of her (the Witches') newfound power. And most of all, he would have to face the truth of Andora's lineage and what it might mean for the future of Fade.

Would the knight's love be enough to keep Andora on the path of light? Or would the shadows of her past consume her?

The fate of the land, the princess, and the knight himself hang in the balance, waiting to be decided within the walls of the keep.

8 The Missions

The Old Keep

Princess Andora (whom you love and adore) has been captured by the Evil Lord Rorbit who has thrown her in the dungeons of his old Keep. You are Sir Seirol the Brave and have been tasked with rescuing her.

To do this, you must find the key to her shackles and then save her. Bring her with you as you exit the Keep the way you came in. But, beware. Some of the corridors are misleading... and the Evil Lord Rorbis' vial henchmen are roaming about.

Also collect gold to buy things later and use health packs to stay healthy and strong.

The Orb of Inx

You have saved the princess, well done.

But now the Evil Lord Rorbit has put you in his sights. He will do everything in his power to see that you pay dearly for your insolence.

To vanquish the Evil Lord Rorbit you must first find the source of his powers. It is a small spherical object called the Orb of Inx. It is located deep in the bowels of the Evil Lord Rorbit's Keep in the Land of Fade.

Find it and then escape the castle.

The Evil Lord Rorbit has unleashed a legion of foul spirits to hinder you. Good luck to you Sir Seirol.

The Curse of Inx

You have acquired the Orb of Inx and in so doing diminished the powers of the Evil Lord Rorbit. However, the orb has a curse upon it and any who take it.

The curse will make you disoriented and unable to move in a normal fashion.

To have the curse lifted permanently you must find the incantation hidden somewhere in the castle. Then bring the incantation to the witch so she can release you from the curse.

Along the way you might find the root of the Orasty plant. Eat it to ease the symptoms of the curse of Inx.

As always, keep a weather eye out for trick passage-ways and when you have completed the task escape The Old Keep the way you came in.

The Witch's Wood

You have found the incantation and must now bring it to The Witch of the Wood so she may release you from the curse of Inx.

She lives hidden deep in the enchanted forest that is fraught with danger. To find her, solve the riddle of the "*Kon-ami-con-tra*".

You still have the curse of Inx upon you and are unable to navigate normally.

Be on guard for The Witch's Wood is enchanted. Those who choose to enter are never the same afterward.

It is said that the trees and path-ways move as if living and one must always be on the lookout for danger.

Rorbit's Vault

The Witch of the Wood has released you from the Curse of Inx. You are free from its evil grip for now.

In return for her professional services, the Witch of the Wood has asked that you liberate a book that is dear to her from a vault that is hidden within the Evil Lord Rorbits Keep.

If you fail, the curse of Inx will return and you will succumb to a slow and torturous death.

If you succeed, she will grant you riches and power beyond your imagination.

A Book of Spells

Well done good Sir Seirol, well done indeed. The Witch of the Wood has what she wants and you are now free from the Curse of Inx forever.

However, the Witch of the Wood is not a very nice person. While you are no longer afflicted by the Curse of Inx, she does not want any mortal (such as yourself) to have any knowledge of the book of spells.

She will be using all of her magic and minions to thwart your escape from the woods and destroy you!

Get back to the keep – with all possible dispatch!

The Many Rorbits

You made it!

Not only have you ticked off the Witch of the Wood but the Evil Lord Rorbit is quite displeased with you as well.

He has used his magic powers to create an army of Rorbit clones

Find the *actual* Evil Lord Rorbit and...

... Terminate... with extreme prejudice.

The Seeker

You have defeated the Evil Lord Rorbit. Let the good people of the Land of Fade rejoice and celebrate.

You have learned that while you were on your quest to defeat the Evil Lord Rorbit, the Witch of the Wood took Princess Andora and has been keeping her captive in her lair.

Rumours have been whispered that the Witch is trying to turn Princess Andora into an evil sorceress in hopes to replace the Evil Lord Rorbit with her.

If that happens... The Witch of the Wood and an unwitting Princess Andora will turn the land of Fade into a nightmarish wasteland full of hate and despair.

Find the witch and save the princess ... (again).

The Hex

Well done Sir Seirol! But that wasn't the Witch of the Wood. It was Princess Andora trying to defeat you. Now why in the land of Fade would Princess Andora, whom you love and adore, try to hurt you?!?... The Good Sir Seirol?

She must be partially (or maybe even totally) brainwashed into thinking she is an Evil Sorceress.

Capture her **without hurting her**. She may be saved just yet!

The Trials of Seirol

Alas, you were too late in saving the Princess Andora. She is now an evil sorceress destined to rule the land of Fade with an iron fist. Her mind will forever be under the spell of the Witch of the Wood.

The Witch of the Wood has assembled an army of **Rorbis' minions, fierce animals, and ghostly apparitions** to find and kill you once and for all.

Some say she has even brought the Evil Lord Rorbit back from the Netherworld. You must flee the land of Fade at once. Escape with your life... if you can.

The Lost Quatraines of Oralda

The Grand Vizier Oralda was born many years ago with the gift of foresight. Unfortunately, his gift also came with the curse of madness. His visions of the future were obscured by clouds and clouded with fictional whimsey and the ravings of a deranged lunatic. During his lifetime he displayed such stunning genius as to be the first in the land of Fade to capture the healing qualities of the Orasty root and fill a vial with its goodness. Yet he also exuded such insane chaos that he had to be locked in the dungeons of Lord Rorbit's Keep for his own safety and the safety of the Land of Fade. He was once found in the Witches' Wood hanging by his left foot from a tree insisting that the moon and all of her friends sat down to dinner the night prior and conspired to perform the most heinous of acts unto his burgeoning tomato plants and their offspring.

Needless to say, he was quite daft.

While locked in the keep, he bode his time by recording his knowledge of the world in a book he called, "My Life in Code: A Treatise on Lexical Analysis" which is now taken as absolute canon in the land of Fade and beyond. But in secret, he also recorded ten visions of the future that he had while writhing in delusional bliss on the hard stone floor of Lord Rorbit's dungeon. Last August, they were found tucked into a crack in the wall and here they are in their entirety. They are broken up into 4-line "stanzas", hence they have been dubbed "Quatraines".

They could be ravings or they could be genius. Who knows? That is for the reader to decide.

Nonetheless he died alone and in the dungeons some winter morn nigh on 50 years ago this very day.

Quatrain 1

Eight stoic eyes guard the chambers
When one should see them
One should go back then
to retrieve the key that is needed.

The maiden weeps inside the keep.
She awaits her savior patiently.
Her captor bides his time
while the matriarch sleeps outside.

Quatrain 3

The watchers know the way.
The wayward know to watch
for giant apparitions.
Stay on the path.

Under the layers are
moving layers.
You think you know,
but alas... you don't.

Quatrain 2

Two steps forward, one step back,
The spectres have hidden your quarry.
Pray they don't steel your face.
And steal your soul.

You will likely get lost
In which case you can count
on the torches to shed some light
on your whereabouts.

There is a sphere within.
There is a Knight without.
Do not take from the Evil Lord
Lest ye seek his wrath.

Quatrain 4

To find the woman
First find the Steely
Then employ the tried and true
timeless trick of the wrist.

It releases the adders in Discord.
It's 30 lives to some.
Its in your hands.
Contra-rians be damned.

Quatraine 5

A true Shakespearean hag
demanded remittance
forthwith to the tune of a tome.
Seek and ye might find!

The book is key
A key gets the book
The walls move
The halls are alive

Quatraine 6 (actually, this is a playlist)

“On the Run” - Pink Floyd
“Runnin’ with the Devil” - Van Halen
“Runnin’ Down a Dream” - Tom Petty
“Run to You” - Bryan Adams

“Run Like an Antelope” - Phish
“Run for the Roses” - JGB
“Runaway” - Del Shannon
“Take the Money and Run” - Steve Miller Band

“Born to Run” - Bruce Springsteen
“Run to the Hills” - Iron Maiden
“Runnin’ on Empty” - Jackson Brown
“Long May You Run” - The Stills-Young Band

Quatraine 7

I saw a snail crawl slowly on the blade,
A symbol etched in flesh and steel and fear.
The cost of will, the dream that men betrayed,
All echoed in the silence I hold dear.

The river winds through madness to the throne,
Where whispered truths weigh heavier than lies.
To see the world, one must be all alone—
And curse the light that blinds the inner eyes.

Quatrain 8

All is not as it seems.
The wicked one and her kin conspire.
She is willing to abide.
Killing will open doors.

Quatrain 9

Strong are the Enlightened
but Not the Emboldened.
Strong are the Enraged,
Even in times of Strife.

Now are the End-times.
Now is the time of the Witch,
Who has the world
Engulfed in her Spell.

Even Now as the evil one lays in wait.
Someone shall rise.
Seirol the brave, With staff in hand
will denounce such evil!

No one is safe,
None shall escape
Even the strong will
succumb.

Quatrain 10

Don't Slam the Door
Don't Be a Stranger (or Do... that works too)
You'll Be Missed (by someone, I'm sure)
Parting is such sweet Relief

9 Alternative Missions

These are not officially sanctioned by the League and under no circumstances should be attempted during Official Tournament play, but could be entertaining for the user if he or she so desires to *think outside the rabbit-hole*.

This is not an exhaustive list of alternative missions. It is merely an attempt to itemize some of the favourites among the kids these days. They are also not in any specific order, unless you consider the order that they are in to be specific in some way; if that is the case then they are in a very specific order.

- **The Clean Sweep:** Clear all rooms in all levels of all enemies, treasure, and health-packs. There are between 20 and 23 different rooms per level.
- **The Good Samaratin:** Complete a level killing as few of Lord Rorbit's and the Witch of the Wood's minions as possible.
- **The Capitalist:** Collect as many gold coins as possible by the end of all 10 levels.
- **The Go Go Speed Racer:** Complete all 10 levels in as short a time as possible.
- **The Hack-n-Sack:** Use a machine-language monitor or debugger to hack the game so that there are NO enemies and gold is in *every* room.
- **The Lewis and Clark:** Create 10 hand-drawn maps - one for each level - that show how rooms (and clearings in the Witches' Wood) are *actually* connected regardless of *worm-hole passages*.
- **The Name Dropper:** Complete all the missions as normal **EXCEPT** pretend that the Brave Sir Seirol is actually the Brave Sir *Roland*.

For Serious Inquiries Only

In the off-chance that you wish to contact any of the actual people portrayed in this game, I have included their absolute and (in Seiol and Rorbit's case) indirect addresses.

Please send a S.A.S.E. to:

The Grand Vizier Rivera Oralda
8 Bitword Row
Unit 3b
S. Taldy, Land of Fade 64222

OR...

Phaora Woodwitch
42 Hexington Avenue
Asland, Land of Fade 49374

OR...

The Bit and Nibble
C/O Seiol Stadey
6569 Spritely Blvd.
Butterfield, Tramiel-upon-Gould, Sussex
England

OR...

Andora Batsheet
1011 Assembly Square
Mostek, Pennsylvania, U.S. of A. 38911

And you may visit Rorbit's place of rest at:

Our Lady of Eternal Raster Lines
16 Gazette Lane
Poke's Peek, Wyoming, U.S. of A. 69105
(Plot # 32768)